StoreLink Admin Panel — Founder Study Guide (A → Z)

Audience: Founder / Head of Product
Product: StoreLink marketplace ops console
Repo: `admin-storelink` (GitHub: `ad-storelink`)
Stack: Next.js 16 · React 19 · Supabase (same DB as mobile + web) · Vercel
Version note: Reflects the admin console as of the ops rebuild (Phases 0–2b). Ads stay **OFF** until go-live.

How to use this guide

Read once end-to-end (≈45–60 min), then keep as a desk reference.

1. **Mental model** (what this panel is)
2. **Access & roles** (who can do what)
3. **Shell** (how you move around)
4. **Every desk A→Z** (what each page does)
5. **Money, trust, growth** (how systems connect)
6. **Your operating cadence** (daily / weekly)
7. **Hard rules** (what not to do)

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1. Mental model — what the admin panel is

StoreLink has three client surfaces:

Surface	Repo	Users
Mobile app	`store-link-mobile`	Buyers & sellers
Web app	`storelink-web`	Buyers & sellers
Admin	`admin-storelink` / `ad-storelink`	Your ops staff

All three talk to the **same Supabase project**. The admin does **not** invent a second database. When you approve KYC, resolve a dispute, or flip a feature flag, you are changing production state the apps read.

What admin is for

- Trust & safety (KYC, reports, suspensions)
- Money & escrow (orders, bookings, disputes, payouts, stuck payments)
- Catalog inspection (products, services, listing locks)
- Social moderation (reels, stories, comments, chats, communities)
- Ads review (seller Boosts + house ads) — delivery gated until you turn ads on
- Growth & comms (broadcasts, banners, scheduled announcements)
- Platform knobs (staff, settings, flags, experiments, geo, legal, observability)

What admin is not

- Not a second storefront
- Not a place to "message as the user" from P2P Chats (read-only investigations)
- Not automatic marketing send for scheduled announcements (you still press Send)

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2. Access & roles (RBAC)

Login flow

1. Go to `/login`
2. Sign in with email + password (Supabase Auth)
3. You must also exist in `admin_users` with `is_active = true`
4. Otherwise you land on **Unauthorized**
5. Login is recorded (device / session context) for staff audits

Roles

Role	Intent
super_admin	Founder / eng lead — full access, staff, settings, kill switches
moderator	Trust & safety — KYC, reports, social, users
finance	Treasury — disputes, payouts, clawbacks, transaction ops
support	Care — tickets, lookups, some money desks (no staff/settings)
content	Growth/comms — Content Studio, house ads, some social
analyst	Read-only — sees desks but write buttons hidden; APIs also 403

Three layers of protection

1. **Middleware** — blocks wrong roles from opening a URL
2. **API** (`getApiAdminContext`) — blocks writes even if someone crafts a request
3. **UI** (`canWrite`) — hides buttons for analysts

Sidebar items you cannot open show as **Restricted**.

Single source of truth for who sees what: `src/constants/adminNavigation.ts`

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3. Shell — how you navigate

Eight sidebar groups

1. **Overview** — morning pulse
2. **Trust & safety** — users, KYC, reports, support, listing integrity
3. **Money** — finance, payments, orders, bookings, clawbacks
4. **Catalog** — products, services, flash drops
5. **Social** — spotlight, reels, stories, comments, chats, communities
6. **Ads** — house ads, campaigns, reporting
7. **Growth** — content, curations, loyalty, referrals, onboarding, analytics
8. **Platform** — staff, settings, flags, audit, observability, QA

Everyday shortcuts

- **Ctrl+K / Cmd+K** — command palette (jump to any desk you can see)
- **Country filter** (header) — scope lists/metrics to NG / GH / ZA / KE / CI / EG / RW or ALL
    - **Caution:** with ALL countries, summed GMV/revenue can mix currencies — don't treat that sum as one number

- **Queue badges** (refresh ~every 60s) — pending KYC, ads review, disputes, open reports
- **Mobile** — hamburger opens the full drawer

Patterns on every write desk

- **Confirm** before irreversible actions
- **Reason** (often ≥10 characters + category) written to the **Audit Log**
- Prefer **staging** for experiments; production for real interventions

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4. Every desk A → Z

Roles: **SA** super_admin · **M** moderator · **F** finance · **S** support · **C** content · **A** analyst

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Overview — `/dashboard` · SA M F S C A

Purpose: Morning command center.

See

- Users, GMV, revenue, disputes, pending KYC
- DB latency / system pulse
- Escrow health (escrow balance, pending payouts, product + service disputes, deposit · balance due)
- Disaster recovery shortcuts (stuck payments, webhook, payouts)
- Links into Moderation, Finance, Users, QA

Founder tip: Start here every day before opening tickets.

Users — `/dashboard/users` · SA M A

Purpose: User dossier — the investigation home.

Do

- Search by email / slug
- Open profile: status, verification, phone (Termii), subscription, order/curation counts, disputes, tickets
- Suspend / activate with a clear reason

Touches: account access across the whole product.

Moderation — `/dashboard/moderator` · SA M A · badge KYC

Tabs

1. KYC / Identity
2. Business / CAC
3. Abuse reports
4. Moderation cases
5. Suspension appeals

Do

- Approve / reject identity & business verification (bulk + claim/release assignee chips)
- Work abuse into cases
- Approve appeal (reactivate) or reject with reason

Touches: seller verification badges, business double-check, account reinstatement.

Report Inbox — `/dashboard/content-reports` · SA M S C A · badge reports

Purpose: One queue for user reports + ML borderline flags.

Do

- Claim / release
- Bulk dismiss (with reason)
- Triage here → take action on the **surface desk** (Reels, Stories, Comments, …)

Listing Integrity — `/dashboard/listing-integrity` · SA M S C A

Purpose: Catch bait-and-switch / locked listing identity drift.

Do

- Review content locks & snapshot drift
- Unlock via product/service detail only with reason

Support — `/dashboard/support` · SA S M A

Purpose: Customer care desk.

Do

- Open tickets, read thread, reply as support, resolve/close
- Look up orders / bookings / users in context
- Escalate money → Finance; safety → Moderation

Finance — `/dashboard/finance` · SA F A · badge disputes

Tabs

1. **Dispute Tribunal** — refund buyer or release to seller (product + service disputes)
2. **Withdrawal Watchtower** — approve / reject seller payouts

Always leave a reason. This is money + audit.

Payment Incidents — `/dashboard/payment-incidents` · SA F S A

Purpose: Stuck checkout without hunting UUIDs.

See

- Webhook failures
- Orders stuck in `AWAITING_PAYMENT`

Do

- Mark as paid when Paystack succeeded but the app didn't catch it
- Super Admin can tune alert thresholds

Transaction Ops — `/dashboard/orders` · SA F S

Purpose: Product order lookup & privileged interventions.

Do

- Search by order UUID or Paystack reference
- Prefer **Mark as paid** with a real Paystack ref
- Force Complete / Force Cancel only with strong reason

Related: Payment Incidents for queues; Finance for disputes.

Bookings — `/dashboard/bookings` · SA F S

Purpose: Service / booking lifecycle.

Do

- Lookup by booking UUID or linked payment order
- Force complete / cancel / refund with audit
- Read 30/70 escrow timeline, deposit snapshot, clawback cap

Note: Some refunds create **seller clawback debt** (seller locked until repaid).

Clawback Debts — `/dashboard/clawback-debts` · SA F S A

Purpose: Track company-funded booking refunds the seller owes back.

Do

- Age open debts
- Note / waive / mark manually paid (with categories + reasons)

Service Listings — `/dashboard/service-listings` · SA F S A

Browse / filter services; open detail; unlock locked content with reason.

Products — `/dashboard/products` · SA F S A M

Browse / filter products; open detail; force unlock content when locked.

Flash Drops — `/dashboard/flash-drops` · SA F S A M

Live flash listings; watch end times / price deltas / fake-urgency signals.

Spotlight — `/dashboard/spotlight` · SA M S A

Moderate Spotlight reports: hide / remove / reinstate.

Reels — `/dashboard/reels` · SA M S A

Moderate Explore/Discover reels + reports; optional trust strikes.

Stories — `/dashboard/stories` · SA M S C A

Moderate live stories + reports (expired stories drop off naturally).

Comments — `/dashboard/comments` · SA M S C A

Unified comment-report queue across product, service, spotlight, reel.

P2P Chats — `/dashboard/chats` · SA M S A

Read-only buyer–seller transcripts for investigations.
Every load is audit-logged. Do **not** expect to chat as support here — use **Support**.

Communities — `/dashboard/groups` · SA M S A

List seller communities; force-archive; ban hosts from creating new groups.

House Ads — `/dashboard/house-ads` · SA C A

Platform Discover/Home banners (presets). Activate / pause / end with confirm.
Delivery requires `ads_enabled`.

Ad Campaigns — `/dashboard/ads` · SA M C S A · badge ads

Seller **Boost** desk:

- Approve / reject / pause / **resume** / end
- Bulk actions
- Issue unused budget as Store Coins
- Creative review checklist
- Global `ads_enabled` **kill switch** (Super Admin)

Launch hold: keep platform ads **OFF** until go-live. You can still review & pause while delivery is gated.

Ads Reporting — `/dashboard/ads/reporting` · SA A F

Daily Boost warehouse: spend, billable views, clicks, eCPM, conversions (cron ~01:30 UTC). Read-heavy.

Content — `/dashboard/content` · SA C A

Broadcasts — push to All / Sellers / Buyers (confirm before send; irreversible)
Banners — in-app hero images create / remove
Calendar — schedule announcements; **Send now** or Cancel

- Nothing auto-sends until a human confirms (no send cron yet)

Curations — `/dashboard/curations` · SA M C A

Buyer curation hubs from completed purchases; preview; hide; feature.

Loyalty — `/dashboard/loyalty` · SA F S A C

Platform max reward % and per-seller caps (mirrors mobile Store Rewards 1/2/5%).

Referrals — `/dashboard/referrals` · SA F S A

Invite attributions, reward payouts, fraud heuristics, review queue.

Onboarding — `/dashboard/onboarding` · SA A

Funnel conversion / drop-off aggregates only (no user identifiers).

Analytics — `/dashboard/analytics` · SA A

Daily DAU / GMV / conversion warehouse snapshots (cron ~01:15 UTC).

Super Admin — `/dashboard/super-admin` · SA

- Invite staff with roles
- Suspend / activate staff
- View / revoke admin sessions
- Fast audit tab

System Settings — `/dashboard/settings` · SA

- Maintenance mode (lock app for non-admins)
- Min iOS / Android versions (force update)
- Support phone shown in-app

Geo Policy — `/dashboard/geo-policy` · SA A

Cross-country rules for deep links, checkout, chat, discovery.

Legal & Policy — `/dashboard/legal-policy` · SA C A

Versioned terms / privacy / service policies served to mobile.

Audit Log — `/dashboard/audit` · SA A

Every sensitive admin action. Filter by type / date / search. **Export CSV** for compliance.

Feature Flags — `/dashboard/feature-flags` · SA A

Toggle product/platform flags with reason. Staging-first; ramp slowly (1% → 5% → 20%).
Ads gate also controllable from Ads desk. Ranking v2 kill switches live on **Experiments**.

Experiments — `/dashboard/experiments` · SA A

Home/Explore ranking v2 rollout, calibration, kill switch. Analyst read-only on writes.

Search AI — `/dashboard/search-embeddings` · SA

Gemini embedding coverage for products/services (semantic search quality).

Observability — `/dashboard/observability` · SA A

App + admin events: info / warning / error / critical. Pair with Payment Incidents during outages.

QA Hub — `/dashboard/safety-tests` · SA A

Runbooks, escrow health, staging smoke, CI commerce safety tests — run before risky deploys.

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5. How money works (escrow mental model)

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PRODUCT COMMERCE                          SERVICE / BOOKINGS
————————————————                          ——————————————————
orders (Paystack)                         service_orders (+ payment order)
  AWAITING_PAYMENT → PAID → …               deposit / funded legs
  COMPLETED / CANCELLED / DISPUTE           30% start + 70% complete escrow
disputes → Finance Tribunal                 dispute_state → Finance + Bookings
payouts → Withdrawal Watchtower             refund may create clawback debt
```

Recovery rule of thumb

1. Customer paid, app stuck → **Payment Incidents** or **Transaction Ops** → **Mark as paid** (real Paystack ref)
2. Prefer Mark as paid over blind Force Complete
3. Mass payouts stuck → Finance + check `payout-processor` cron (needs service_role JWT, not anon)
4. Booking refund funded by company → watch **Clawback Debts**

Deposit / balance-due volume appears on Overview **Escrow health**.

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6. Trust & safety loop

1. **KYC** (identity + business) on Moderation
2. **Report Inbox** triage → surface desks
3. **Listing Integrity** for locked / drifted listings
4. **Social desks** for content actions
5. **Users** for account freeze / reactivation
6. **Suspension appeals** for fair reinstatement
7. Close the loop in **Audit Log** + **Observability**

Queues support **claim / release** so two people don't double-work the same case.

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7. Growth & communications

Channel	Desk	Notes
Push broadcast	Content	Segmented; confirm; irreversible
In-app banner	Content	Image + title
Scheduled announcement	Content → Calendar	Manual Send now — not auto
House ads	House Ads	Needs `ads_enabled`
Seller Boost	Ad Campaigns	Review OK while gate off; delivery needs gate on
Loyalty / referrals / curations	Growth desks	Program levers

Ads posture (current): keep `ads_enabled` **OFF**. Review backlog is fine; do not turn delivery on until launch decision.

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8. Founder operating cadence

Every morning (15–25 minutes)

1. **Overview** — Escrow health + Disaster Recovery panel
2. Sidebar badges — KYC · disputes · reports · ads pending
3. **Payment Incidents** — webhook spike / stuck payments
4. **Observability** — Error / Critical last 24h
5. Skim **Finance** if finance staff aren't on shift

Weekly

- Spot-check **Audit Log** (high-risk actions)
- Confirm **ads still OFF** pre-launch; clear review backlog
- **Content calendar** — send due items manually; prune banners
- **QA Hub** before risky deploys
- **Feature Flags / Experiments** — no surprise prod ramps
- **Clawback Debts** aging
- **Super Admin** → **Sessions** — revoke stale staff sessions

Incident severity cheat sheet

Severity	Example	First desk
SEV-1	Webhook down / error spike	Payment Incidents + Observability
SEV-2	Mass payouts stuck	Finance + cron health
SEV-3	One customer paid, order stuck	Transaction Ops → Mark as paid

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9. Hard rules — what NOT to do

1. **Do not turn** `ads_enabled` **on** until go-live.
2. **Do not force-complete** when a Paystack reference exists — mark as paid.
3. **Do not** skip reasons on money / account / moderation actions.
4. **Do not** treat "All countries" GMV as a single currency total.
5. **Do not** assume scheduled announcements auto-fire — press Send.
6. **Do not** ramp flags / ranking experiments first in production.
7. **Do not** expect house ads or Boosts to deliver while ads gate is off.
8. **Do not** use P2P Chats as a support reply channel.
9. **Analysts cannot write** — UI and API both block.
10. **Do not** leave ex-staff sessions alive — revoke in Super Admin.

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10. App feature → admin control map

In the app	Admin desk	What you control
Orders / checkout	Transaction Ops, Payment Incidents	Lookup, mark paid, force status

Escrow / disputes	Finance, Overview escrow	Refund / release
Seller payouts	Finance → Withdrawals	Approve / reject
Bookings / services	Bookings, Clawback Debts	Force status, refund, clawbacks
Seller Boost ads	Ad Campaigns	Review, pause, resume, kill switch
Platform banners (ads)	House Ads	Publish / pause (needs ads on)
Feature rollout	Feature Flags, Experiments	Toggle + ramp
Support tickets	Support	Reply / resolve
Merchant KYC	Moderation	Approve / reject
Reels / Stories / Comments	Social desks + Report Inbox	Hide / remove / reinstate
Users	Users	Dossier, suspend / activate
Push / banners	Content	Broadcasts, banners, calendar
Errors / outages	Observability	Incident forensics
Who did what	Audit Log	Filter + CSV export
Staff access	Super Admin	Invite, suspend, revoke sessions
App lock / force update	System Settings	Maintenance, min versions

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11. Engineer file map (when you need depth)

Concern	Path
Middleware RBAC	`middleware.ts`
Nav + roles + badges	`src/constants/adminNavigation.ts`
API auth	`src/utils/auth/apiAdmin.ts`
Shell (sidebar, Ctrl+K, country, badges)	`src/app/dashboard/layout.tsx`
Role / canWrite	`src/hooks/useAdminRole.ts`
Queue claim/release	`src/hooks/useQueueAssignments.tsx`
Operator guide (shorter)	`docs/ADMIN_OPERATOR_GUIDE.md`
Desk pages	`src/app/dashboard/**/page.tsx`
Admin APIs	`src/app/api/admin/**/route.ts`

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12. One-page cheat sheet

Start: Overview → badges → Payment Incidents → Observability
Money stuck: Mark as paid > Force complete

Seller can't post: Moderation KYC / Business
User reports content: Report Inbox → surface desk
User angry about refund: Finance Tribunal + Bookings timeline
Seller owes after refund: Clawback Debts
Need to announce: Content → confirm → send
Ads review only: Ad Campaigns — leave kill switch OFF
Something broke: Observability + Audit Log
Who has access: Super Admin staff + sessions

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